VITYARTHI

DIGITAL LITERACY(CSE0001)

PROJECT REPORT

Submitted by

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Introduction

As a Student Digital Ambassador at **VIT Bhopal University**, my primary responsibility is to assist my peers in navigating the complexities of the modern digital landscape. This role involves everything from helping fellow students create professional online identities to ensuring they communicate safely and responsibly within the academic and professional spheres.

To fulfill the requirements of the **CSE0001 - Digital Literacy course**, I have developed this Digital Literacy Portfolio. This portfolio is designed to be presented to the faculty committee and shared with my batchmates as a comprehensive resource for digital success. The project is structured around five distinct tasks, each mapping to a core module of the curriculum:

- **Module 1**: Creating a visual awareness resource.
- **Module 2**: Building a professional student digital presence.
- **Module 3**: Exploring coding practice and cloud collaboration platforms.
- **Module 4**: Mastering professional email etiquette and social media responsibility.
- **Module 5**: Developing expertise in cybercrime awareness and prevention strategies.

By organizing all deliverables within a single GitHub repository, I have established a permanent digital footprint that demonstrates my technical proficiency and commitment to digital citizenship. This report documents my work, observations, and reflections throughout each phase of the project.

TASK-1 Create a Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

Project Report

I designed my Digital Literacy infographic using Canva, a versatile and user-friendly design platform that enabled me to combine creativity with structured presentation. The tool offered a wide range of templates, icons, and customization options, which helped in creating a visually coherent and engaging layout.

The infographic illustrates key aspects of digital literacy in a clear and organized manner. It begins with the definition of digital literacy, followed by sections on useful tools for students, safe internet practices, professional online presence, and email etiquette. Each segment is supported by minimal yet meaningful illustrations, enhancing understanding while maintaining visual balance. The use of a blue, technology-inspired theme reflects the essence of the digital era and adds a modern aesthetic to the design.

One particularly interesting aspect of this project was understanding how visual elements such as color schemes, typography, and spacing influence clarity and audience engagement. However, maintaining a balance between informative content and visual simplicity proved slightly challenging. Overall, this experience strengthened my ability to present information effectively while applying both digital and creative skills.

TASK-2 Build Your Student Digital Portfolio

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Overview of Platforms As part of my role as a Student Digital Ambassador, I have established a professional digital presence across three primary platforms: GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle. I configured my LinkedIn profile to highlight my current status as a First Year B.Tech student in Computer Science and Engineering at VIT Bhopal, ensuring my education section includes my expected graduation year. On GitHub, I created a specialized profile README repository containing my branch and year to serve as a technical landing page. Lastly, I joined Kaggle to begin exploring data science and machine learning resources.

Purpose and Future Plans These platforms will serve as the foundation of my professional identity over the next four years. I plan to use GitHub to host and version-control my academic coding assignments and personal projects, while LinkedIn will be my primary tool for networking with industry professionals and tracking internship opportunities. Kaggle will allow me to participate in competitions to sharpen my analytical skills. By maintaining these profiles early in my college career, I am ensuring that my digital footprint remains professional, minimal, and ready for future recruiters.

TASK-3 Explore Coding & Collaboration Platforms

Project Report

Platforms Used and Activities For the technical portion of this task, I created an account on HackerRank to practice my programming skills. I successfully completed the "Solve Me First" beginner-level challenge, which helped me familiarize myself with the platform's environment and automated testing system. For the collaboration component, I utilized Google Workspace to develop a 'Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz'. This involved designing a Google Form with five specific questions, including both multiple-choice and short-answer formats, to gauge the digital proficiency of my peers.

These tools are essential for my development as a B.Tech student at VIT Bhopal. Platforms like HackerRank provide a structured way to improve my problem-solving logic and prepare for future technical interviews. Meanwhile, mastering cloud collaboration tools like Google Forms and Sheets allows me to collect and analyze data efficiently for group projects and research. As a Student Digital Ambassador, these skills enable me to guide others toward the right resources for studying and professional collaboration.

TASK-4 Draft a Professional Email & Etiquette Guide

Project Report

Communication Scenario and Analysis In this task, I practiced professional correspondence by drafting two essential emails: a formal request for an assignment extension to a professor and an inquiry for a summer internship. Both drafts focused on maintaining a respectful tone, using clear subject lines, and following a formal structure with appropriate salutations and sign-offs. Additionally, I developed a "Social Media Do’s and Don’ts" checklist to guide peers on maintaining a positive digital footprint, emphasizing the importance of privacy and professional conduct.

Key Learnings This exercise highlighted how easily digital communication can be misinterpreted if not structured correctly. One common issue in academic settings is "ghosting" or overly casual messaging, which can lead to missed opportunities or professional friction. I learned that a concise, well-structured email is far more effective than a long, disorganized one. These skills are vital for my future as a B.Tech student, as clear communication is a prerequisite for successful collaborations and professional networking.

TASK-5 Cybercrime Awareness Case Study & Prevention Guide

Project Report

Reflections on Cybercrime Research While researching **Phishing** for my case study, I was most surprised by how sophisticated social engineering tactics have become, often using psychological triggers like "urgency" or "account suspension" to bypass a user's critical thinking. The step-by-step breakdown of how a single fraudulent link can lead to immediate identity theft or financial loss was a significant realization. As a result of this research, I will personally change my habit of clicking on links directly from emails or SMS messages. Instead, I will manually navigate to official websites or use verified bookmarks to ensure my data remains secure.

Key Learnings and Student Safety As a Student Digital Ambassador, I have learned that awareness is the primary defense against online threats. By documenting a realistic scenario, I can help my peers recognize red flags, such as mismatched URLs or requests for sensitive information. Furthermore, emphasizing official reporting channels like the National Cyber Crime Portal (cybercrime.gov.in) and the 1930 Helpline ensures that students know the exact steps to take if they encounter a cybercrime. This task has reinforced that digital literacy is not just about using tools, but about maintaining constant vigilance in an interconnected environment.

Conclusion

The completion of this Digital Literacy project marks a significant milestone in my transition as a first-year B.Tech student at VIT Bhopal University. By fulfilling the role of a Student Digital Ambassador, I have moved beyond being a mere consumer of technology to becoming a responsible and professional digital citizen. This comprehensive portfolio, hosted on GitHub, serves as a "living" testament to the diverse technical and communication skills I have acquired across all five modules.

Through the creation of a visual infographic in Task 1, I learned to distill complex digital concepts into accessible resources for my peers. Setting up a professional presence on LinkedIn, GitHub, and Kaggle in Task 2 has provided me with a foundational brand that I will continue to cultivate over the next four years of my engineering journey. Task 3 expanded my technical horizons by engaging with coding platforms like HackerRank and collaboration tools like Google Workspace, which are essential for modern academic success.

Furthermore, practicing formal email etiquette and social media responsibility in Task 4 ensured that my digital interactions remain professional and effective. Finally, the deep dive into phishing and cybercrime prevention in Task 5 has instilled a permanent habit of vigilance, equipped with the knowledge of official reporting channels like the National Cyber Crime Portal. Ultimately, this project has not only fulfilled a 1-credit requirement but has also provided me with a professional identity and a secure digital mindset that will benefit me throughout my academic and professional career.

References

- **Canva:** Graphic design tool for infographics**.**

https://www.canva.com

- **GitHub**: Version control and professional repository hosting**.**

https://github.com

- **LinkedIn**: Professional networking and portfolio management.

https://www.linkedin.com

- **Kaggle:** Data science and machine learning community.

https://www.kaggle.com

- **HackerRank:** Technical skill practice and coding challenges.
https://www.hackerrank.com

- **Google Forms:** Cloud-based collaboration and data collection.

https://forms.google.com